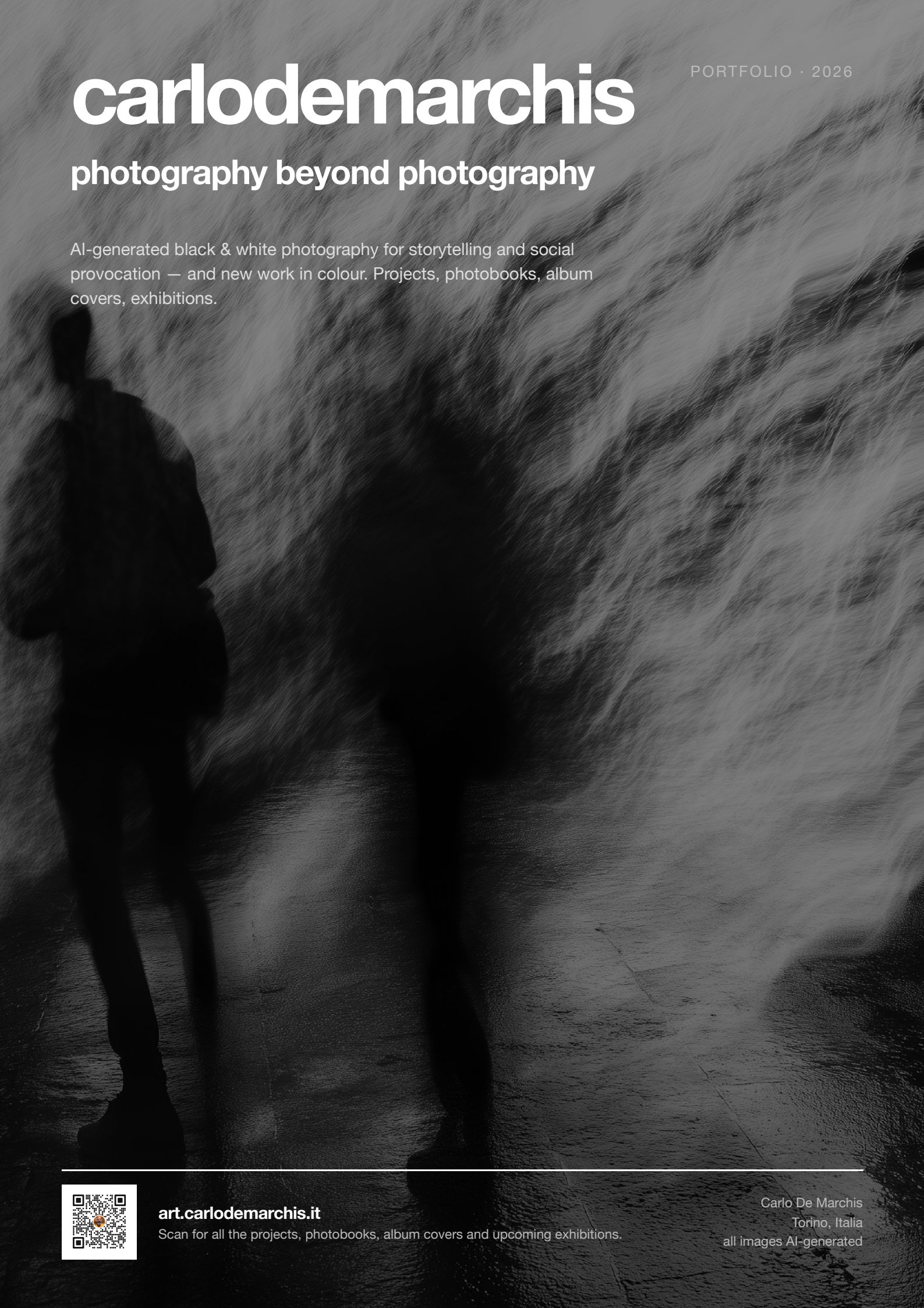
# carlodemarchis

PORTFOLIO · 2026

## photography beyond photography

AI-generated black & white photography for storytelling and social provocation — and new work in colour. Projects, photobooks, album covers, exhibitions.



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Carlo De Marchis
Torino, Italia
all images AI-generated



2025–2026 · SPECIAL PROJECT · BLACK & WHITE

# Torino Moves

The building in the city, the city in the building — for Reply, on the meeting-room glass of Caserma De Sonnaz, Torino

**The making of an AI photography project for Reply, on the meeting-room glass of Caserma De Sonnaz in Torino — in the author's own words, from the book "Torino Moves".**

A company at the front edge of technology asked an artist to put a living city onto the glass of its meeting rooms, and we made it together. Reply had taken on an enormous building in the centre of Torino, the former Caserma De Sonnaz, a nineteenth-century cavalry barracks of around twenty thousand square metres built on the ground of the old Cittadella, and turned it into a second home for the company. The architects, ACPV ARCHITECTS Antonio Citterio Patricia Viel, kept the skeleton intact and rebuilt the inside as a place of glass and light.

It started with street photography: a small book with a long title, Walking in the Streets of Turin with the Phone in My Hands, Scrolling Feeds and Sending Messages. Reply liked those photographs because they were not the postcard Torino. Then the real problem arrived, and the real problem became the project. The building is full of glass meeting rooms, and glass is a problem when you need to discuss something confidential while clients walk the corridors a few metres away. What if the photographs lived on that glass, printed in a translucent way, doing the practical job of privacy while they did something else as well?

The concept we settled on was movement. Torino moves. I did not want views of the city hung on the walls like windows onto somewhere else; I wanted the building immersed in Torino and Torino immersed in the building. Children running through a fountain. Dancers caught mid-turn on the stage of the Teatro Regio. Musicians holding the middle of a street while the crowd blurred past. Travellers crossing the great hall of Porta Nuova. Students on the steps down to the Po, the cafés under the porticoes, the book fair at Lingotto, riders on a cold morning on the hill above the city. The city doing the ordinary things it does, held still for a second and then let go.

The work was room-specific, then glass-specific. A meeting room is not one sheet of glass: it is a sequence of panes, sometimes seven, with white borders between, a door in the middle, an opening at the top, a corner. I went to the building two or three times a week while the glass went up, sat in half-built rooms and moved photographs around the map of the two floors until the rooms felt right together.

When it came to printing, I asked to put the prompt into the picture. Each image is built from the letters of its own prompt, the blank spaces between words acting as the dots of a newspaper halftone; even a pure white area is made of letters printed white. From across the room you read it as an image. Closer, it stops being an image and becomes letters you can read, and touch: the print has a slight relief under your fingers. A sentence that runs through five languages — about art, innovation and AI — runs through the rooms as well.

None of it happened alone. Fabio Zappelli opened the door and trusted the idea early; Paolo Corsaro and Emanuele Dedonno in Reply's design operations were with me through the whole middle



2026 · SERIES · COLOUR

# 46°16′48″ N, 86°40′12″ E

The Continental Pole of Inaccessibility

**46°16′48″ N, 86°40′12″ E. The Continental Pole of Inaccessibility: the point on land farthest from every sea — 2,560 km from the coast on average (three published calculations give 2,645, 2,510 and 2,514 km) — in the Gurbantünggüt (Dzoosotoyn Elisen) desert, Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, People's Republic of China.**

This is the first work born from that concept: a series of full-colour photographs, in the look of late-1970s 35 mm Kodak Ektachrome, of people who went to the beach at the place where the beach is farthest. Swimsuits, sun hats, cool boxes and towels, laid out on the dry steppe, with nobody and nothing around for thousands of kilometres.

The pole is also a question, asked in two directions.

- **Outside you** — what is your pole of inaccessibility, the point of you farthest from everyone else?
- **Inside you** — if you look inside yourself, what is there, at the point farthest from your external appearance?

I have the feeling this can go beyond these first images, and I am having conversations with people who work in different styles and formats about it.

What else can be born from this — a book, a film, a poem, a map, a monument, a ritual, an expedition? That is what the project wants to explore.

Available as museum-quality fine art paper prints, editions of 10, in different sizes, on request.



Carlo De Marchis
Torino, Italia
all images AI-generated



2025 · SERIES · COLOUR

# People at an exhibition

Watching the people who are watching.

**I have always been drawn to exhibitions — of photography first, then of contemporary art in all its forms. The white room, the sequence, the silence that is never quite silent, the moment when an image you had only seen on a screen suddenly has a size, a surface and a distance from your body. I go as often as I can, and I go back.**

Somewhere along the way a second obsession grew next to the first: watching the people who are watching. The couple who disagree in front of a painting without saying a word. The man who reads the wall text longer than he looks at the work. The woman who photographs the photograph. The child who finds the only thing in the room nobody else noticed. A group that lines up in front of a mural and, without meaning to, becomes its missing foreground.

At some point I realised I was spending more time looking at the visitors than at the art, and that this was not a distraction from the exhibition but another way of attending it. A work is not finished when it is hung. It is finished every time someone stands in front of it, and every one of those encounters has its own composition: a back, a shoulder, a pair of glasses, a coat against a colour.

"People at an exhibition" is a series of AI-generated colour photographs about those compositions. The works on the walls are invented; the way people stand in front of them is not. Each image is built as if seen from across the room: figures caught between the art and the viewer, reflected, silhouetted, absorbed, bored, or so still that it is hard to say which side of the frame they belong to.

It is a small tribute to the audience — the half of every exhibition that is never in the catalogue.

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2025 · SERIES · COLOUR

# Quiet Chaos

Collages of cities, vegetation and the people who might live in between.

**At six in the morning, along the Po, Turin wakes up in silence. The trees on the river draw shadows that change the geometry of the city while almost everyone is still asleep. It is in those moments that I started asking myself whether we have ever really understood what "urban culture" means.**

For years I thought of a city as a weave of people, spaces and signs: palaces, museums, festivals, galleries, clubs, communities. A reassuring definition, and an incomplete one. It leaves out the natural dimension — the one that accompanies the city in silence, protects it, regulates it, makes it liveable. Above all the trees, which more than any other living thing are part of its design, and the part we forget first.

Trees are the real urban planners. They grow while we sleep, they shift perspectives, they create microclimates. They do not decorate the city: they project it. And yet we keep talking about them as furniture rather than as living architecture.

"Quiet Chaos" is a series of colour collages where that order is reversed. Fragments of façades, towers, tramlines and shop windows are layered with palms, ferns, trunks and undergrowth, and with figures who look as if they were photographed in another decade — pasted, taped, torn at the edges, like pages from a sketchbook of a city that has not been built yet. The chaos is quiet because nothing in it is violent: the vegetation does not take the city back, it moves in, and the city lets it.

It is a way of imagining how we may live next. Not the smooth, rendered "green city" of the brochures, but something closer to what a street actually feels like when a canopy closes over it: cooler, slower, less legible, more alive. A city where the architecture has to negotiate with something that keeps growing after the architects are gone.

Planting a tree today is a subversive act. Whoever plants knows they will not sit in the full shade of what they planted. In a city that measures everything in electoral terms, seeding for

Available as museum-quality fine art paper prints, editions of 10, in different sizes, on request.



2025 · INSTALLATION · COLOUR · WORK IN PROGRESS

# Presence / Absence

An immersive data experience.

**An immersive data experience.**

This installation transforms a space into a living, breathing canvas where data becomes art. Through real-time processing it captures a building's natural rhythm — its network pulses, physical movements and spatial flows — and translates them into an evolving atmosphere of light and shadow.

Inspired by contemporary light artists and cutting-edge AI technology, Presence/Absence renders invisible data streams visible through an abstract language of colour and motion. Golden halos blend with deep shadows while ethereal blues drift through the space, creating an ever-changing composition that responds to the building's actual usage patterns.

The installation processes multiple data streams:

- physical movement through reception areas
- network activity levels
- building access patterns
- WiFi connection density

Each data point influences the visual environment: warmer colours intensify with higher activity, motion blur responds to data flow rates, and shadowed forms shift with physical movement patterns. Yet the result is never literal — instead, it creates an atmospheric experience that transforms technical data into pure spatial energy.

The piece sits at the intersection of data visualization, ambient computing and contemporary art. It offers a way to experience a space's digital dimension while maintaining complete privacy and abstraction, and it can be scaled and customised to a specific space and its data.

**Creating art with AI es una experiencia fascinante.**
**La tecnología has opened new frontiers pour les artistes et créatifs.**
**Con l'intelligenza artificiale, we can explore estilos únicos y generate œuvres surprenantes.**
**C'est un processus collaboratif entre la creatividad humana and machine learning.**
**Les algorithmes can analyze miles de opere d'arte and apprendre patrones y técnicas.**
**Cela permet aux artistes to experimentar con nuevas ideas y estilos in modi mai visti prima.**
**La fusion de la créativité humaine y la potenza computazionale está révolutionnant il mondo dell'arte.**
**L'arte generata dall'AI défie nos perceptions and empuja los límites, creando un nouveau paradigme artistique.**

2025 · INSTALLATION · BLACK & WHITE · WORK IN PROGRESS

# BABEL

Languages merging, minds converging.

**Languages merging, minds converging.**

This installation presents four interwoven narratives about artificial intelligence and artistic creation, where languages flow into each other just as human creativity flows into machine learning. English, Spanish, Italian, and French merge and separate like colors in a digital painting, creating an intentionally fluid reading experience.

Each version tells the same story differently, demonstrating how we maintain our linguistic diversity and human expressiveness even as we embrace AI's capabilities. The seamless transitions between languages mirror our ability to adapt and understand across boundaries — both cultural and technological.

As you read these texts, notice how your mind naturally navigates between languages, finding meaning in the mixture. This linguistic fluidity serves as a metaphor for our relationship with AI: we're not losing our human touch; we're expanding our creative vocabulary.

The texts are designed to surprise and empower — showing that even as AI becomes part of our creative process, our human ability to find meaning in complexity remains uniquely ours. This is not about AI replacing human expression, but about humans masterfully orchestrating new forms of artistic communication.



2025 · SERIES · BLACK & WHITE

# tempospazio

Siamo frammenti di tempo sospesi nello spazio.

**A fragile dance between the visible and the fleeting.**

Time doesn't flow — it bends, slips, disappears. Space is the stage where we dissolve, a flickering echo of our passing. Bodies in motion, minds adrift, lives slipping past the present moment.

These images are not posed. They hold waiting, disorientation, the rush. A way to witness the invisible, the unspoken, the nearly forgotten.

We remain suspended, inside a time that refuses to be held.

Available as museum-quality fine art paper prints, editions of 10, in different sizes, on request.



2024–2025 · SERIES · BLACK & WHITE

# Who's Missing?

Vintage computers, empty chairs, classical European squares.

**"Who's Missing?" explores our complex relationship with technological progress through a series of AI-generated photographs that pair vintage computers with empty chairs against classical European architecture. This visual narrative creates scenes that are simultaneously nostalgic and prophetic, challenging viewers to consider our current anxieties about artificial intelligence through the lens of past technological revolutions.**

The empty chairs serve as powerful symbols of human absence, raising questions about displacement, progress, and agency in technological advancement. The deliberate use of black and white photography focuses attention on the interplay between the geometric precision of the computers and the organic flow of classical architecture, whose enduring presence stands in stark contrast to the dated technology in the foreground.

As we grapple with unprecedented advances in artificial intelligence, these images invite viewers to consider how previous generations faced their own versions of technological anxiety. The vintage computers, once cutting-edge, now appear almost quaint, yet in their era they inspired similar debates about human obsolescence that AI generates today.

The project challenges both techno-utopianism and neo-Luddite resistance by suggesting that the absence of humans might be a choice rather than an inevitability — that our relationship with technology is not predetermined but shaped by our collective decisions and values.

Available as museum-quality fine art paper prints, editions of 10, in different sizes, on request.




2024 · PHOTOBOOK · BLACK & WHITE

# Walking in the streets of Turin with the phone in my hands, scrolling feeds and sending messages

A photobook of 4×4 grids: fifteen AI-generated frames and one fragment of text per page.

**"Walking in the Streets of Turin with the Phone in My Hands, Scrolling Feeds and Sending Messages" is a photobook project that explores the intersection of our physical and digital experiences in the modern world. Through a series of AI-generated black and white images and fragmented text, the artist invites us to consider the impact of technology on our perception and memory of the urban landscape.**

The project was born from a moment of realization during a walk through the bustling streets of Turin on March 28th, 2024. As the artist navigated the crowded Via Garibaldi, their attention divided between the physical world and the digital realm of their phone, they became acutely aware of the duality of their experience. This epiphany inspired them to create a visual record of the day's journey, not through traditional photography, but by harnessing the power of artificial intelligence.

The resulting photobook is a collection of 4×4 grids, each containing 15 AI-generated black and white images and a single text box with an abstract description of the artist's experience. The text, which varies from page to page, serves as a contextual anchor, grounding the ethereal visuals in the specific time and place of their creation.

The images themselves are a mesmerizing blend of blurred figures in crowded streets, with some individuals in focus while others are lost in a swirl of motion and light. This visual approach captures the essence of the modern urban experience, where the boundaries between the individual and the collective, the real and the virtual, are constantly shifting and blurring.

The monochrome palette of the images lends them a timeless quality, as if they could be scenes from a distant past or glimpses of a possible future. The absence of color also serves to emphasize the interplay of light and shadow, the stark contrasts and soft gradations that define the urban landscape of Turin. Through these haunting, dreamlike visuals, the artist invites us to question the nature of memory in the digital age.

**Full text at art.carlodemarchis.it/projects/walking-in-the-streets-of-turin/**

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2023 · SERIES · BLACK & WHITE

# They are staring at us

Are we failing the next generation?

**Are we failing the next generation?**

These faces generated by AI represent the bitter disappointment of millions of youth worldwide. Their precisely simulated despair conveys an unspoken accusation of intergenerational betrayal. For too long we have favored immediate comfort over long-term vision.

- **Climate inaction** — not making enough progress to meet emissions reductions goals to avoid catastrophic warming that will greatly impact youth worldwide.
- **Wealth inequality** — allowing excessive consolidation of wealth while poverty remains entrenched across much of the global population.
- **Social injustice** — we fail to fix systemic discrimination based on race, gender, sexual orientation and other factors that will continue to marginalize many children.
- **Access to education** — not prioritizing education access for all, especially girls and marginalized groups, limiting potential.
- **Public health** — insufficient investment in healthcare and disease prevention, including maternal & child health.
- **Hunger and nutrition** — not addressing food security and malnutrition issues that stunt millions of children.
- **Water scarcity** — inadequate global cooperation to address looming water shortages.
- **War and conflict** — continued resort to violence and unwillingness to address root causes of conflicts that displace youth.
- **Human rights** — ongoing violations of human rights, especially against indigenous/minority groups, women, children.
- **Digital divide** — failure to close global internet and tech access gaps that will disadvantage many youth.
- **Irresponsible industry** — allowing corporate interests to trump protections for human and environmental health.
- **Short-term thinking** — lack of forward-looking vision and long-term planning for sustainable development.
- **Intergenerational justice** — overall failure to sufficiently incorporate the interests of future generations into policymaking.

We must think beyond ourselves — for the consequences of our neglect touch us all. Watch these photos often as a reminder to

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2023 · SERIES · BLACK & WHITE

# A black and white portrait of [redacted] with a camera

A cast of Andy Warhol lookalikes, cameras ready, waiting for their 15 minutes.

**Andy Warhol, the legendary pop artist, fascinated the world with his explorations of repetition, mass production, and celebrity. In his iconic screen prints he repeated images of Campbell's soup cans, Marilyn Monroe, and other icons of consumerism and popular culture. Warhol embraced the power of replication, turning the mundane into the mesmerizing through sheer multiplication.**

In this series of black and white portraits, the spirit of Warhol is reimagined for the age of artificial intelligence. A cast of Andy Warhol lookalikes pose with cameras, echoing Warhol's own penchant for photographing friends, muses, and celebrities. Yet each portrait adds its own twist, as if the continual copies have introduced mutations and new ideas.

Just as Warhol mass-produced his screen prints of Marilyn, these images of faux Warhols repeat, with slight variations that catch the eye. The blurred boundaries between reality and representation were core to Warhol's vision. Here, the multiplying lookalikes question the notion of authenticity and originality in art. The iterated portraits become an exploration of simulacra — representations without clear origin, like Warhol's screen prints themselves, endlessly reproducible.

In the flickering frames of the accompanying video, the succession of faux Warhols bombards the viewer with distorted echoes of the legendary artist. The portraits cascade by, at once familiar yet estranged. This dizzying procession becomes a comment on our media-saturated age, where fame is fractured through infinite replication online.

Just as Warhol captured and multiplied the icons of his time, this work reflects on identity and image-making today. Ultimately, this series is a tribute to Warhol's legacy,

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**art.carlodemarchis.it/projects/a-black-and-white-portrait-with-a-camera/**
Scan for this project, the other series, photobooks and upcoming exhibitions.

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2022 · SERIES · BLACK & WHITE

# A black and white portrait of [redacted] in the style of [redacted]

Sixteen portraits per frame. None of them are real people.

**Being able to distinguish what is real from what is unreal is a core capability of the human brain. Something our brain is executing multiple times every minute to drive us safely through our daily life. Both science and art have experimented with that limit many times.**

Today we may have a different challenge ahead of us: technology is making that limit very blurred, and we may need to retrain our brain for it. The artist is giving you a taste of what may become more and more common in the near future. It may be more confusing than now. Scan through these portraits and sense how you feel at the end of the journey.

This is a series of 16 (4×4) black and white photographs portraying people in different moments of their lives. They all have one thing in common: they are not real people. All of them have been generated by artificial intelligence.

Each set of 16 has been created using an OpenAI algorithm that converts text to image. The sentence (prompt) being used is "A black and white portrait of x in the style of y" (created in September 2022).

- 4 photographers from various periods and styles.
- 10 black icons from various fields and ages.
- Each set of 16 portraits is created by AI from the same "person".
- Each row of 4 photographs is created by AI in the same style of a photographer.

Available as museum-quality fine art paper prints, editions of 10, in different sizes, on request.

# Photobooks, covers, exhibitions.

## PHOTOBOOKS

- A black and white portrait of [redacted] in the style of [redacted] · 2023
- A black and white portrait of [redacted] with a camera · 2023
- They are staring at us · 2023
- Walking in the streets of Turin with the phone in my hands, scrolling feeds and sending messages · 2024
- No Story · 2026 · private edition

## ALBUM COVERS

Cover art for the music released as Abe Murakami, An Ignorant Soul, 100 Operai Elettrici, Nuru Odu Awiro and The Night I Swam.

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## UPCOMING

- **46°16′48″ N, 86°40′12″ E — Torino Contemporary Art Week 2026**
  Flashback Habitat, Corso Giovanni Lanza 75, Torino · 2026
- **La settimana dell'arte contemporanea da Tono Metzger**
  Tono Metzger, Torino · 2026

## EXHIBITIONS

- **Brainstorm — creative session for the new project**
  Flashback Habitat, Corso Giovanni Lanza 75, Torino · 2026
- **Stanza d'artista — Torino Contemporary Art Week 2025**
  Flashback Habitat, Corso Giovanni Lanza 75, Torino · 2025
- **Liquida Photofestival 2024 — Where images flow**
  Torino · 2024
- **Liquida Photofestival — Winter Edition, at Paratissima Eye Contact**
  Cavallerizza Reale, Torino · 2023